

Jessica Gallagher

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ABOUT ME

Senior DevOps Engineer with 20 years in DevOps/Infrastructure, currently at Nova Tech Group. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Grafana, Terraform and Nginx.

CAREER HISTORY

Senior DevOps Engineer, Nova Tech Group

2015-12 — 2026-02

- Reduced incident MTTR from 12 hours to under 30 minutes with better alert routing and runbooks.
- Cut container image sizes by 45%, shortening cold starts across the fleet.
- Automated 6 manual runbooks, saving an estimated 40 engineer-hours per month.
- Introduced infrastructure-as-code with AWS, eliminating manual provisioning entirely.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with Kubernetes, bringing mean time to deploy under 15 minutes.

Platform Engineer, Clearwater Systems

2010-12 — 2015-08

- Wrote the platform team's paved-road documentation, cutting onboarding from weeks to days.
- Introduced secret rotation and least-privilege IAM across 15 accounts.
- Migrated 2 services to AWS, cutting monthly infrastructure spend by 40%.
- Designed the multi-region failover strategy and led the game-day exercises that proved it.

Junior Platform Engineer

Shopify | 2005-04 — 2010-10

- Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 2 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.
- Ran the on-call rotation for 20 production services, sustaining 99.9% availability.
- Hardened Azure environments ahead of SOC 2, closing 20 critical findings.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

PhD, Communications

Mitchelltown State University | 2002 — 2005

Thesis: "Framing effects in crisis communication"

Bachelor, Communications

South Dennisview Institute of Technology | 1999 — 2002

CORE COMPETENCIES

Grafana • Terraform • Nginx • AWS • Kubernetes • Docker • GCP • Bash • Kafka • Azure • Datadog • PyTorch • CI/CD • Figma • Scala • TensorFlow

PROJECTS

Match-day predictor

Small model in Figma predicting league results. Beats the naive baseline; still loses to the bookmakers.

GCP utility library

Open-source helper library for GCP, ~100 GitHub stars. Wrote the docs and handled issue triage.

LICENCES & CERTIFICATIONS

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) — Scrum.org, 2025

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2017

Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate — Databricks, 2019

LANGUAGES

English – Fluent

Mandarin – B2

Spanish – C1